

HEALTH, SAFETY & ENVIRONMENTAL (HSE) MANUAL

TENNESSEE LAWN CARE, INC.

Known as “TLC Team”

865 Johnson Rd, Oliver Springs, TN 37840

Phone: 865-693-5069

Established 1984 · Family-Owned & Operated

President: Ron French

Vice-President: Michelle French

Effective Date: December 1, 2025

Revision: 2025-02

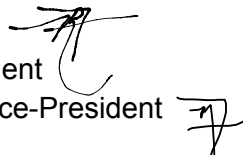
1. HSE POLICY STATEMENT

Tennessee Lawn Care, Inc. is committed to the safety and health of every employee, subcontractor, customer, and the public we serve. Our goal is simple: **zero harm**. We will comply with or exceed all TOSHA, federal OSHA, and Tennessee-specific regulations, including the 2025 updates on PPE fit, heat illness prevention, and hazard communication.

Signed

Ron French – President

Michelle French – Vice-President



December 1, 2025

2. SCOPE

This manual applies to all TLC employees, subcontractors, and visitors at every job site, shop, yard, office, or vehicle under our control in the State of Tennessee (NAICS 561730 – Landscaping Services).

3. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

- **President (Ron French)** – Ultimate accountability, annual review, resource approval
- **Vice-President (Michelle French)** – Daily HSE oversight, training coordination, TOSHA liaison
- **Crew Leaders / Supervisors** – Stop-work authority, daily JHAs, PPE compliance checks

- **Every Employee** – Follow safe practices, report hazards, stop unsafe work, wear properly fitted PPE

4. HAZARD IDENTIFICATION & RISK ASSESSMENT

Every job starts with a completed Daily Job Hazard Analysis (JHA). Key hazards include traffic, heat illness, Cold illness prevention, chemicals, safe clearances from power lines, mowers, trailers, trenching, and slips, trips & falls, working at heights, dropped objects, proper communication, operating heavy equipment.

5. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT (PPE) – 2025 UPDATE

All PPE must properly fit each employee (29 CFR 1926.95(c), effective Jan 13, 2025).

Minimum daily requirements:

- ANSI Z87 safety glasses
- High-visibility Class 2 apparel
- Steel-toe/comp-toe boots
- Cut resistant gloves
- Hearing protection (when required) Additional PPE issued as needed (hard hats, chaps, face shields, chemical-resistant gloves, sunscreen, full body harnesses, 6ft/12ft lanyards.).

6. SAFE WORK PRACTICES

- Traffic control & high-visibility clothing
- Heat illness prevention (water, rest, shade, acclimatization, Work rest cycles. – 2025 protocol)
- Mower & power-tool safety (ROPS, kill switches, chaps)
- Trailer loading & securement
- Chemical handling (GHS labels, SDS in every truck)
- Trenching & excavation (call 811, slope/shore)
- Fall protection at 6 ft or higher
- Lockout/Tagout for all repairs
- **Cold weather work rest cycles:**

Wind Chill
Temperature
(°F)

Risk Level

Recommended Work
Cycle (per hour)

Key Controls & Timeframes

32 to 21	Caution	Unlimited (continuous work OK)	Monitor for early symptoms (shivering); provide warm break areas; schedule breaks every 2 hours for 15 min in heated space.
20 to 0	Increased Risk	60 min work / 15 min rest	Insulated clothing/layers; wind barriers; rotate tasks; 15-min rest in warm shelter every hour.
-1 to -20	High Risk	45 min work / 20 min rest	Heated enclosures for breaks; anti-exposure suits if wet; limit exposure to 45 min bursts; medical monitoring for vulnerable workers (e.g., diabetics).
-21 to -40	Extreme Risk	30 min work / 30 min rest	Minimal exposure; use heated vehicles/tools; no lone work; immediate evacuation if symptoms appear.
Below -40	Life-Threa tening	No outdoor work	Cancel operations; provide emergency warming stations; full-body protection if unavoidable.

Wind Chill Calculation: Use NOAA/OSHA wind chill chart (e.g., 10°F air temp + 15 mph wind = -4°F wind chill). Apps like OSHA's NIOSH Heat Stress App can adapt for cold.

Timeframes: Cycles are per hour; adjust for acclimatization (new workers need 50% shorter cycles initially). Rest in heated areas (>70°F).

TN-Specific: No state additions; TOSHA adopts federal guidelines. Local ordinances (e.g., Nashville Metro) may require breaks below 20°F, but none statewide in 2025.

Employer Responsibilities (General Duty Clause)

- **Risk Assessment:** Evaluate wind chill, duration, wetness, and worker factors (age, health).
- **Controls:** Layers (wool/synthetics), heated breaks, hydration (cold reduces thirst), buddy system.
- **Training:** Annual cold stress talks (per 29 CFR 1926.21).

- **Monitoring:** Watch for hypothermia (confusion, shivering); provide PPE like insulated gloves.
- Proper communication (hand signals & phone calls)
- Dropped objects (always stay vigilant & wear your hard hat when working below)
- Slips trips & falls (wear slip resistant boots & watch out for uneven ground or holes)
- Working at heights (always stay vigilant and tied in at all times)

7. TRAINING

- New-hire orientation (Day 1)
- Weekly documented tailgate talks
- Annual training: heat illness, fall protection, hazard communication, first aid/CPR, pesticide applicator licensing
- Mental health awareness session (OSHA 2025 emphasis)

8. INCIDENT REPORTING & INVESTIGATION

All injuries, near-misses, spills, and property damage are reported **immediately** to Michelle French. Incident reports are completed the same day and investigated within 24 hours. Corrective actions are tracked to closure.

9. EMERGENCY RESPONSE PLAN

Scene safety analysis, Contact EMS, Emergency contacts and procedures are posted in every truck. First-aid kits, AED, and spill kits are maintained and inspected monthly. Proper Fire extinguishers expected monthly.

10. SUBCONTRACTOR MANAGEMENT

Subcontractors must provide proof of insurance, EMR ≤ 1.0 , and sign our safety agreement before starting work. TLC retains stop-work authority.

11. ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

- No runoff into storm drains
- Proper disposal of clippings, trash, and chemicals
- Secondary containment for fueling
- Spill kits on every truck

12. INSPECTIONS & AUDITS

- Pre-use vehicle/trailer/equipment inspections
- Monthly shop & yard inspections
- Annual third-party or TOSHA consultation review

13. DISCIPLINARY POLICY

Willful safety violations result in progressive discipline up to and including termination.

14. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

This manual is reviewed and re-signed every January. Updates are made immediately when new TOSHA or OSHA standards are published.

Appendices

A – Safe Work Procedures

B – Forms (JHA, Incident Report, PPE Fit Log, Vehicle Inspection)

C – Emergency Contacts

D – SDS Locations

Signed



Ron French – President

Michelle French – Vice-President

December 1, 2025